Copilot at work: prompts to keep handy

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Goal
What you want done.

Context
What is going on.

Source
Where to look.

Expectations
The shape of the answer.

COPILOT CHAT

Catch up after time away

I was away for the past week. Summarize what happened in this chat. List key decisions, open questions, and action items. Include the owner for each action item if it is mentioned.

Name the span of time and ask for owners.

Prepare for tomorrow's meeting

Prepare me for tomorrow's meeting. Use the meeting invite, the related email thread, and the notes from the last meeting. Summarize the background, key topics, unresolved issues, and questions I may want to ask.

Name the three sources so it does not pick its own.

Find a detail across your work

When did someone first propose the current project timeline? Show me where you found it.

Ask for the source and open it before you repeat the detail.

OUTLOOK

Summarize a long email thread

Summarize this thread. What was decided, what is still open, and what do I need to do?

Ask for decisions and actions, not just a summary.

Draft a reply to a customer

Draft a reply to the customer. Thank them for the update, confirm our team is reviewing the project, and let them know we will share the next steps by Friday. Use a professional tone and keep it to about 150 words.

State the tone and the length every time.

TEAMS

Recap a meeting you missed

Summarize this meeting. List the decisions that were made, the action items with owners, and any open questions that still need answers.

Needs a meeting that was recorded or transcribed.

WORD

Draft a document from notes

Create a first draft of a project update based on these notes. Include a short summary, progress so far, current risks, and next steps for the team and the customer.

Paste or point at the notes first.

EXCEL

Show insights in a table

Analyze this table and tell me the main trends, outliers, and changes over time.

Format the data as a table with headers first.

Add a formula column

Add a new column called Total Cost that multiplies Hours by Hourly Rate for each row.

Check a few rows by hand before you trust the column.

POWERPOINT

Make a first-draft deck from a document

Create a 10-slide presentation from this document for a team of project stakeholders. Use a professional, clear tone.

Name the audience, the slide count, and the tone.

Before you trust it: open the sources, check names, numbers, and dates, read it once as the recipient.

Drafted with Copilot Chat on a personal Microsoft account.